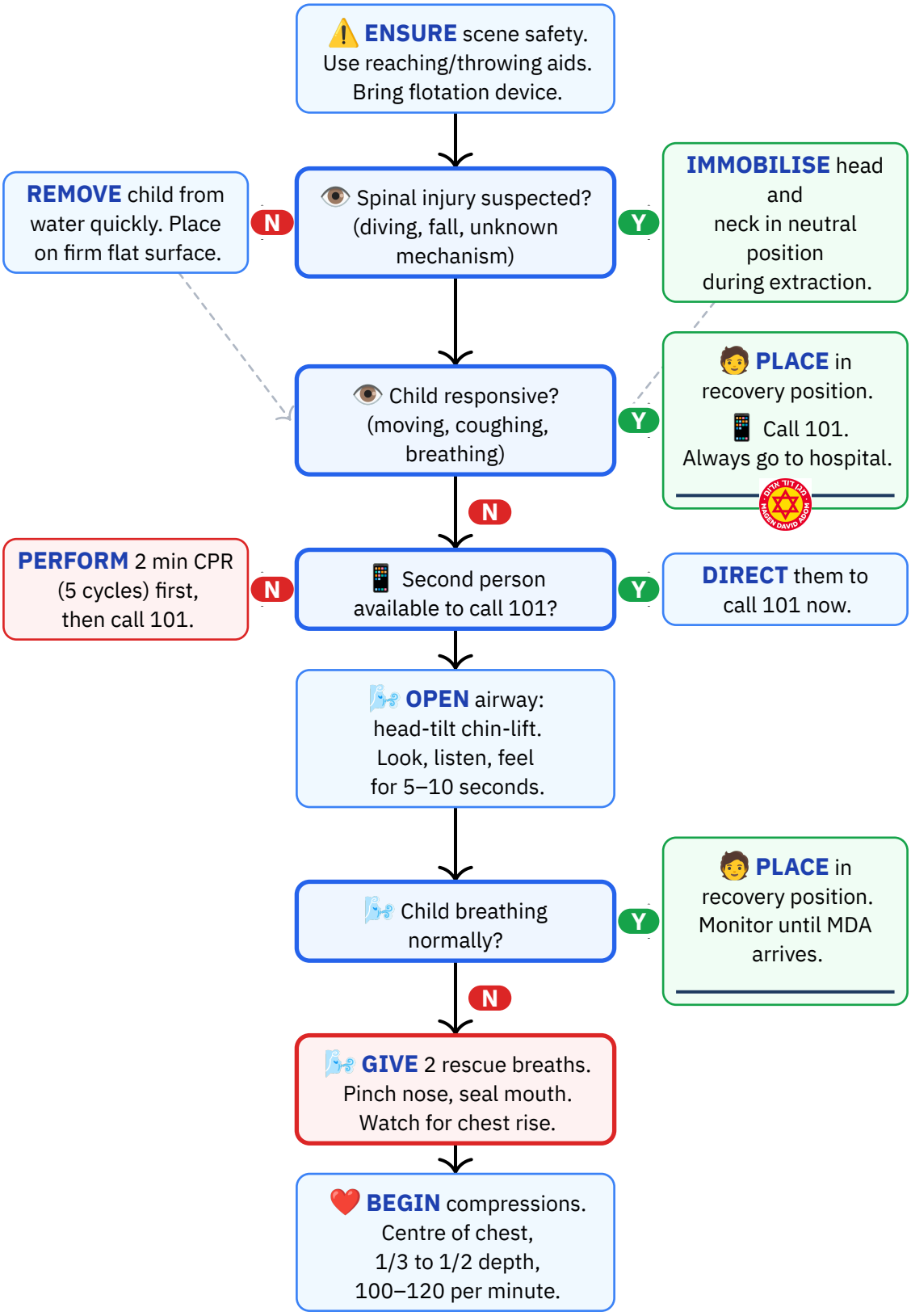

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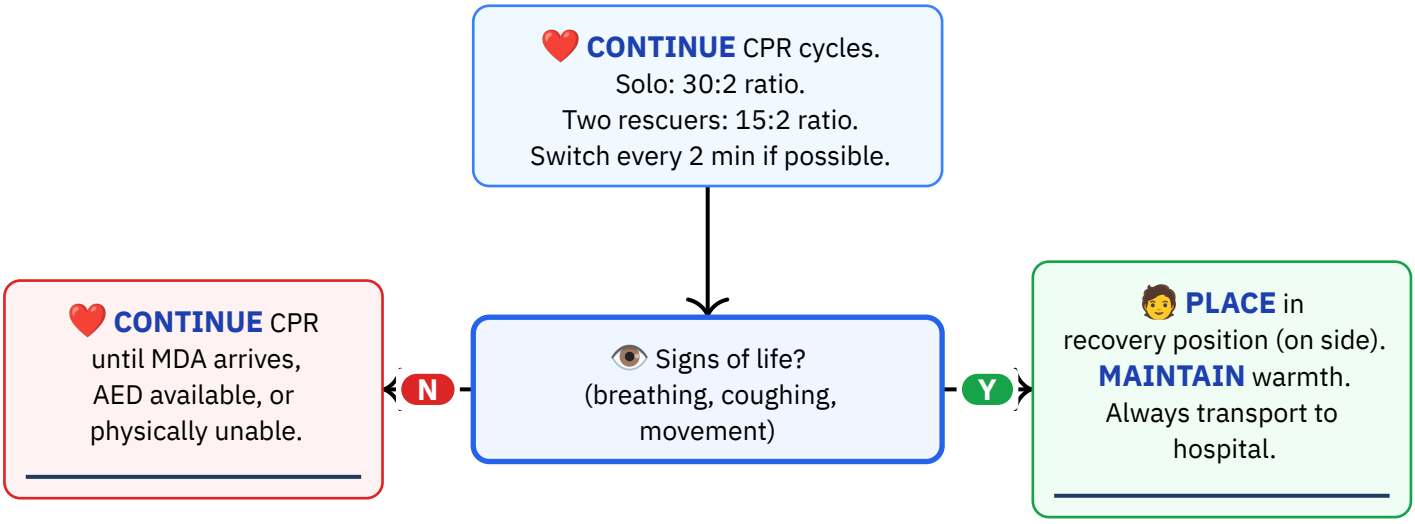
CPR Continuation & Recovery



All drowning victims MUST go to hospital

Secondary drowning (delayed pulmonary oedema) can develop hours after the event, even if the child initially appears to recover fully. Electrolyte imbalances can also occur.

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Reference Notes

DO NOT:

✕ **Do NOT attempt to remove water from the lungs** — this is impossible and can endanger the victim.
✕ **Do NOT perform abdominal thrusts (Heimlich)** to expel water — not effective for drowning and risks aspiration.
✕ **Do NOT delay CPR** to attempt water removal.
✕ **Do NOT use compression-only CPR for drowning** — rescue breaths are essential (hypoxic emergency).
✕ **Do NOT assume the child is fine** if they regain consciousness — always transport to hospital.
✕ **Do NOT enter the water** unless you are a trained water rescuer with a flotation device.
✕ **Do NOT use excessive ventilation force** — can cause gastric distention in children.

Equipment needed:

— Reaching aid (pole, rope, towel) or throwing aid (flotation device)
— Firm, flat surface for CPR
— Blanket or covering for warmth (hypothermia prevention)

Hebrew Terminology — מונחים בעברית

English	עברית	Pronunciation
Drowning	טביעה	tvi-A
Water	מים	MA-yim
Swimming pool	בריכת שחייה	bre-KHAT skhi-YA
CPR	החייאה	ha-kha-ya-A
Rescue breaths	הנשמות	han-sha-MOT
Chest compressions	לחיצות חזה	lkhi-TSOT kha-ZE
Breathing	נשימה	nshi-MA
Recovery position	תנוחת התאוששות	tnu-KHAT hit-o-she-SHUT
Ambulance	אמבולנס	am-bu-LANS
Emergency	חירום	khe-RUM
The child is not breathing	הילד לא נושם	ha-YE-led lo no-SHEM
Call an ambulance	תזמין אמבולנס	taz-MIN am-bu-LANS

Source: Magen David Adom (MDA) — Drowning First Aid Protocol for Children
URL: https://www.mdais.org/101/first-aid
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